Choose between ASP.NET and ASP.NET Core

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No matter the web app you're creating, ASP.NET has a solution for you: from enterprise web apps targeting Windows Server, to small microservices targeting Linux containers, and everything in between.

ASP.NET Core

ASP.NET Core is an open-source, cross-platform framework for building modern, cloud-based web apps on Windows, macOS, or Linux.

ASP.NET

ASP.NET is a mature framework that provides all the services needed to build enterprise-grade, server-based web apps on Windows.

Framework selection

Review the table below to determine which framework is most appropriate for your needs.

ASP.NET Core	ASP.NET
Build for Windows, macOS, or Linux	Build for Windows
Razor Pages is the recommended approach to create a Web UI as of ASP.NET Core 2.x. See also MVC, Web API, and SignalR.	Use Web Forms, SignalR, MVC, Web API, WebHooks, or Web Pages
Multiple versions per machine	One version per machine
Develop with Visual Studio, Visual Studio for Mac, or Visual Studio Codeusing C# or F#	Develop with Visual Studio using C#, VB, or F#
Higher performance than ASP.NET	Good performance
Choose .NET Framework or .NET Core runtime	Use .NET Framework runtime

ASP.NET Core scenarios

- Razor Pages is the recommended approach to create a Web UI as of ASP.NET Core 2.x.
- Websites
- APIs
- Real-time

ASP.NET scenarios

- Websites
- APIs
- Real-time

Resources

- Introduction to ASP.NET
- Introduction to ASP.NET Core